

Introduction

The Second World War brought many changes to the San Francisco Bay Area. Among these changes was the expansion of the Negro population of the Area. The reaction of the communities in the region to this phenomenon followed the same course as their reaction to the Oriental population of the region. Where prior to the war a large amount of discrimination was leveled at people of Oriental origin, this discrimination was now directed toward the Negro people, too.

The expansion of the Negro population brought with it a greater need for housing on the part of its members. Private housing has not been readily available to this minority group. A scarcity of private housing plus the application of racial restrictions to much of this housing has compelled the Negro population to look to public housing to fill its needs.

Public housing is available for families that qualify. Supplementing the qualifications for public housing, however, are two factors which are detrimental to racial minority groups. It is the policy, in many public housing projects, to put aside areas or buildings for the use of these groups. This policy is known as a segregation policy. In order to maintain a policy of segregation or to limit the number of people from various racial groups in a project, racial quotas are used to govern the admission of minority groups into a project. These factors necessarily limit the amount of public housing available to racial minority groups.

In regard to public housing in the Bay Area, the Negro has been the subject of greater segregation than the Oriental. Since the war, the application of a segregation policy in some communities has been only to Negroes rather than to non-Caucasians in general. Hence, the material in this study will deal only with the effect of racial policies and practices in public housing upon the Negro population in the Bay Area.

This thesis is a study of racial policies and practices in public housing in the Bay Area. The purpose of this paper is to set forth an account of the application of racial policies in a Federally-managed public housing project that houses all racial groups, Codornices Village.

National and regional policies form the basis for the racial practices in Codornices Village. It is an intent of this paper to examine this background by looking at national and regional policies, as reflected through Federal agencies, pertaining to race relations.

An examination of the background for the racial practices in Codornices Village should include an idea as to racial practices in other public housing projects in the Bay Area. Local policy originates with the local public housing agency in each community. This level of policy-making, although not directed by Federal agencies, makes use of national policy, as reflected through Federal agencies, to initiate local policy. It is an intent of this paper, therefore, to present the racial occupancy patterns of local housing authorities in six of the Bay Area communities, and to show,

thereby, the interpretations and influence of national policy at a local level.

Before telling the story of Codornices Village, it would be well to look at the history of public housing in the United States, and especially at those programs in which the Federal government took an active part, to see if there was a precedent set for such housing as Codornices.

Codornices Village is a non-segregated housing project. It would be interesting to trace the history of segregation in public housing and to find out what the Federal government has done in past housing programs, and what pattern Federal officials have followed in those projects throughout the country (similar to Codornices) which are directly operated by the Federal government.

The history of the racial policies employed at Codornices Village may be reviewed in terms of the administration of a public housing program by Federal officials. Therefore the early development of this public housing project should be taken into consideration. Such factors as the need for extra housing during the war, the answer to this need in the form of public housing, the selection of a site for a public housing project (Codornices Village), and the attitude of the communities concerned toward this public housing project all have an important bearing upon the racial policies followed in the management of this project.

Very little information in regard to race relations may be found in written statements or manuscripts. In order to obtain such information, other than national and regional

policies, the author was obliged to interview people who had been or are officials or members of organizations connected with public housing in the Bay Area. The files of the San Francisco Regional Office of the Public Housing Administration proved a good source of data, as did documents issued from the central office of the Public Housing Administration in Washington, D.C. Local documents, such as the weekly minutes of the Berkeley City Council meetings and articles written on Bay Area conditions, were also found to be extremely useful.